

Northstar Technical Guide

A fictional guide for demonstrating PDF extraction, search, and summarization.

1. System Overview

Northstar is a small reporting service with an ingestion step, a validation step, and a Markdown report writer. It accepts approved source exports and produces a dated report folder. The demonstration system has no external customer data.

2. Operating Procedure

Place an approved input in the staging area, run validation, review the validation summary, and publish only after the required fields are present. Keep the original input unchanged so an operator can reproduce a report.

3. Validation Rules

Required columns must be present, identifiers must be unique, and an empty input must fail with a clear diagnostic. Validation failures should identify the rule and the affected field without including the source payload.

4. Recovery and Rollback

Every generated report is written to a versioned directory. If a report is incomplete, keep the failed output for diagnosis and restore the previous approved version. Do not delete the original input as part of recovery.

5. Release Checklist

Check	Expected result
Data contract	Required fields and owners are documented
Pilot	Five successful scheduled reports
Alerts	Failure route has been tested
Rollback	Operator can restore the last approved report

6. Troubleshooting

If validation fails, compare the input against the data contract and inspect the diagnostic summary. If publishing fails, preserve the staged output and use the rollback checklist. Escalate only after confirming the input, validation result, and output version.

7. Example Run

An operator stages a synthetic export, validates the required columns, reviews the row count, and publishes a Markdown report. The operator records the output version and keeps the source export available for the next scheduled run.

8. Design Notes

The service favors small, reversible steps. It does not perform automatic migrations, real-time dashboard updates, or arbitrary uploads in the first release. Those features require separate design and operational review.